Barsha Maharjan

Senior Product Designer

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New York, USA

EXPERTISE

Strategic

Product vision & roadmap, Impact metrics, Opportunity map, Business outcome, Cross-team collaboration, Team leadership and design mentorship

Design

Complex interface design, Design system, User journey map, Prototype/wireframe, Responsive design, Version control, Documentation

Tech and tools

Claude code, Cursor, HTML/CSS, Figma, Lucid chart, Lottie animation, Illustrator, Jira, Hotjar, Maze

Research

Data driven decision, User testing (moderated/unmoderated), Usability test

ARTICLES

UX Reflex Theory: Lessons from Apple's Searchbar Experiment

UX Collective

EDUCATION

Parsons School of Design

MFA in Design and Technology

New York, USA, 2019

Deans Merit and University Scholarship

Saint Xavier's College

BS in Information Management

Kathmandu, Nepal, 2014

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer CANDID.ORG 2020 - Present

- Led design of Candid's MCP integration with Anthropic's Claude, giving every Claude user AI-powered access to trusted nonprofit and funder data.
- Designed Candid's Fundraising Assistant, an AI tool that helps nonprofits plan strategy, draft outreach, and find funding opportunities, from concept through public launch.
- Designed a Peer Funder Recommendation AI agent that analyzes similar organizations' funding history to surface relevant, high-fit funders for nonprofits.
- Piloted a Generative AI feature that converts complex IRS Form 990 data into readable nonprofit narratives, driving ~90% profile manager adoption.
- Led the end-to-end redesign of registration through checkout, migrating from Cybersource to Stripe to reduce dunning and failed payments and personalize flows for individual and org-level users.
- Boosted retention by 50% for org profile claiming and increased Seals of Transparency submissions by 60% through a research-led UX redesign.
- Led the GuideStar and Foundation Directory redesign within Candid Search, unifying nonprofit and grantmaker discovery for users nationwide.
- Built a scalable design system with variables from scratch, cutting prototyping time by 50% and creating consistency across 7 product teams.

UX Designer and Developer COREWEAVE 2019

- Designed and developed the revamp of Concierge Renders website, a 3D rendering platform.
- Designed social media assets communicating creator-focused brand identity across digital channels.

UX Research Fellow VERIZON 5G, NYC MEDIA LAB, YAHOO SPORTS 2018

- Received $5K grant to research 5G's impact on sports experiences; conducted 80+ interviews via Lean Launchpad over 8 weeks.
- Built a start-up and successfully pitched the demo to investors.

Teaching and Research Assistant PARSONS SCHOOL OF DESIGN 2018 - 2019

- Taught a bootcamp course to incoming graduate students in the Design and Technology program covering front-end development, digital product design, and design thinking and principles.
- Collaborated with Tongji University in China for an interactive course, Motion Capture at a Distance.

UX Designer and Developer FUSEMACHINES 2014 - 2017

- Led end-to-end web projects across tech and education clients, managing design templates, prototypes, and client relationships.

MENTORSHIPS

AIGA NY Mentor 2025

Technology for Equity and Justice Fellowship Advisory group 2022 - Present

MIT Reality Hack Mentor 2024

All Women Virtual Hackathon Mentor 2022

FIGMA PLUGINS

Accessibility Simulator Features: Vision simulator, Motor control analysis and Cognitive load analysis

AI Text and Lorem Ipsum Generator Features: Custom character count, Revert to original text

WCAG Color Contrast Checker Features: Color contrast analysis, Accessible color suggestion